

Equality, Diversity & Accessibility Policy

Fair access and inclusive practice for every young person

15-17 Irlam Road, Bootle, Liverpool, L20 4AE · Alternative Provision for Ages 5–25

ADOPTED POLICY

This policy has been formally adopted by L-Fit Pathways' co-directors and is in effect from the date shown below. Any section still shown in [square brackets and amber text] is organisation-specific detail that remains to be confirmed and inserted - it does not affect the rest of the policy's validity but should be completed as soon as possible.

Version: 1.0 (Adopted)

Date Adopted: 16 September 2026

Next Review Due: 16 September 2027 (or sooner following any legislative change or relevant incident)

1. Statement of Intent

L-Fit Pathways is committed to promoting equality of opportunity, celebrating diversity, and ensuring our provision is accessible and inclusive for all young people, regardless of age, disability, gender reassignment, race, religion or belief, sex, sexual orientation, or any other protected characteristic.

2. Legal Framework

- Equality Act 2010
- SEND Code of Practice 2015 (0–25 years)
- Human Rights Act 1998

3. Our Commitment

- We do not discriminate in access to provision on the basis of any protected characteristic
- We make reasonable adjustments to our activities, premises and communication to support young people with disabilities and additional needs
- We actively challenge discriminatory language or behaviour, from young people, staff or visitors
- We work with families and professionals to understand and meet each young person's individual, cultural and religious needs

4. Accessibility

We consider physical accessibility of our premises and activity venues for young people with mobility needs, and adapt session delivery (pace, format, sensory environment) to meet individual needs identified at referral.

[OUTSTANDING - Adam/Craig to confirm specific physical accessibility features/limitations of the 15-17 Irlam Road premises (e.g. step-free access, accessible toilet)]

5. Referrals & Fair Access

Referral decisions are based solely on our ability to safely and appropriately meet a young person's needs within our provision model, never on a protected characteristic.

6. Training

Staff receive induction training on equality, diversity and inclusion, including unconscious bias and disability awareness.

7. Handling Concerns

Any concern relating to discrimination is treated seriously and handled under our Complaints Policy, or as a safeguarding matter where relevant.

8. Roles & Responsibilities

Adam Byrne and Craig Lloyd hold overall responsibility for equality, diversity and accessibility across L-Fit Pathways.

9. Monitoring & Review

This policy is reviewed annually.

Policy adopted on: 16 September 2026 — Next review due: 16 September 2027